KidsPortal

English Curriculum & Syllabus Guide

Grades 1 – 10 · A reference for parents

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About this guide

This document lists every topic your child covers in KidsPortal's English subject, grade by grade, so you can see exactly what is being taught and when. English is benchmarked primarily to Cambridge Primary & Lower Secondary English (reading, writing, speaking and listening), and also checked against England's National Curriculum for English and the CEFR framework for English learners — with the roughly equivalent US grade band noted for families comparing against Common Core ELA standards. These alignment notes describe the learning stage and skill focus each framework shares with that grade, not a word-for-word copy of any curriculum's official programme of study.

Every topic below is a real, live lesson on KidsPortal — this snapshot lists what your child actually covers, grade by grade. The curriculum is organised into four learning bands (Seedlings, Explorers, Navigators, Pathfinders) that group related skills together regardless of age, so a lesson always matches what your child is ready for. For the most current version, use the interactive curriculum browser on the Curriculum page — this PDF is a point-in-time copy.

Grade 1

B1 · Seedlings band

Phonics and early reading fluency, alongside the building blocks of a sentence — nouns, verbs, adjectives and basic punctuation.

1. Phonics & Spelling Patterns
2. Reading for Pleasure & Fluency
3. Sentence Types
4. Nouns, Verbs & Adjectives
5. Joining Ideas
6. Punctuation Basics
7. Narrative Writing
8. Instructions & Information Texts
9. Poetry & Performance
10. Review: Sentence & Word Building
11. Rhyming Words & Word Families
12. Describing Words (Adjectives in Action)
13. Story Sequencing: Beginning, Middle & End
14. Question Words & Asking Questions
15. Capital Letters & Full Stops Review
16. Retelling a Story in Order
17. Rhyming Words
18. Alphabetical Order
19. Describing People and Places
20. Types of Sentences
21. Retelling a Favourite Story
22. Opposite Words (Antonyms)

HOW THIS ALIGNS WITH REAL-WORLD CURRICULA

Matches the Key Stage 1 (Year 1) National Curriculum for English — phonics, word reading and simple sentence writing — broadly equivalent to US Kindergarten early literacy expectations. This is our Seedlings band, benchmarked primarily to Cambridge Primary English (reading, writing, speaking and listening).

“sound out new words”

“write a sentence about my day”

“tell what happened first, next and last”

Grade 2

B1 · Seedlings band

Reading between the lines, organising ideas into paragraphs, and widening vocabulary with prefixes, suffixes and compound words.

1. Reading Comprehension: Inference
2. Prefixes & Word Families
3. Paragraphs & Text Organisation
4. Conjunctions & Adverbs
5. Direct Speech & Punctuation
6. Descriptive Writing
7. Non-Chronological Reports
8. Apostrophes for Possession
9. Poetry: Figurative Language
10. Homophones & Word Roots
11. Prefixes & Suffixes
12. Compound Words
13. Writing Simple Poems
14. Synonyms & Antonyms
15. Using Commas in Lists
16. Writing a Simple Recount
17. Prefixes (un-, re-, dis-)
18. Writing Instructions
19. Reading and Writing Simple Poems
20. Suffixes (-ful, -less, -ly)
21. Writing a Simple Letter
22. Describing a Story Character

HOW THIS ALIGNS WITH REAL-WORLD CURRICULA

Matches the Key Stage 1 (Year 2) National Curriculum for English, where pupils move from single sentences to short, organised paragraphs — broadly equivalent to US Grade 1 English Language Arts standards. This is our Seedlings band, benchmarked primarily to Cambridge Primary English (reading, writing, speaking and listening).

“sound out new words”

“write a sentence about my day”

“tell what happened first, next and last”

Grade 3

B2 · Explorers band

Skimming and scanning for information, expanding sentences with noun phrases and fronted adverbials, and first steps in persuasive writing.

1. Skimming & Scanning
2. Expanded Noun Phrases
3. Fronted Adverbials
4. Paragraphing for Cohesion
5. Standard English
6. Persuasive Writing
7. Explanation Texts
8. Possessive Pronouns & Apostrophes
9. Narrative Verse
10. Statutory Spelling: Years 3–4
11. Similes & Metaphors
12. Paragraph Structure
13. Persuasive Writing Basics
14. Expanded Noun Phrases
15. Direct Speech & Punctuation
16. Non-Chronological Reports
17. Organising Writing into Paragraphs
18. Persuasive Writing Basics
19. Myths and Legends
20. Simple and Compound Sentences
21. Diary Writing
22. Information and Non-fiction Texts

HOW THIS ALIGNS WITH REAL-WORLD CURRICULA

Matches the Key Stage 2 (Year 3) National Curriculum for English, including the statutory Years 3–4 spelling list — broadly equivalent to US Grade 2 Common Core ELA standards for that band. This is our Explorers band, benchmarked primarily to Cambridge Primary English (reading, writing, speaking and listening).

“write a story with a beginning, middle and end”

“explain why a character acted that way”

“join ideas with because, when and although”

Grade 4

B2 · Explorers band

Comparing texts and themes, using relative clauses and modal verbs, and writing with tension, discussion and figurative language.

1. Comparing Texts & Themes
2. Relative Clauses
3. Modal Verbs
4. Cohesion Devices
5. Parenthesis
6. Discussion Texts
7. Narrative Writing: Tension
8. Formal & Informal Writing
9. Classic & Narrative Poems
10. Word Origins & Etymology
11. Figurative Language
12. Formal vs Informal Writing
13. Editing & Proofreading
14. Apostrophes: Possession & Contraction
15. Conjunctions: Extending Sentences
16. Diary Writing
17. Similes and Metaphors
18. Writing a Playscript
19. Standard English vs. Informal Language
20. Past, Present and Future Tense Review
21. Writing a Balanced Argument
22. Shape Poems and Haiku

HOW THIS ALIGNS WITH REAL-WORLD CURRICULA

Matches the Key Stage 2 (Year 4) National Curriculum for English, with growing sentence complexity and a wider range of text types — broadly equivalent to US Grade 3 Common Core ELA standards. This is our Explorers band, benchmarked primarily to Cambridge Primary English (reading, writing, speaking and listening).

“write a story with a beginning, middle and end”

“explain why a character acted that way”

“join ideas with because, when and although”

Grade 5

B2 · Explorers band

Critical analysis and summarising, active and passive voice, cohesive extended writing, and oracy through debate.

1. Summarising & Critical Analysis
2. Active & Passive Voice
3. The Subjunctive & Formal Structures
4. Cohesion Across a Text
5. Colons, Semicolons & Hyphens
6. Extended Narrative Writing
7. Journalistic Writing
8. SPaG Review
9. Analysing Imagery & Form
10. Oracy & Debate
11. Debate & Argument Writing
12. Analysing Character & Setting
13. Newspaper Report Writing
14. Fronted Adverbials
15. Relative Clauses
16. Balanced Argument Writing
17. Modal Verbs
18. First vs Third Person Narration
19. Writing a Biography
20. Cohesive Devices (Linking Ideas)
21. Using Flashback in Narrative
22. Writing a Newspaper Report

HOW THIS ALIGNS WITH REAL-WORLD CURRICULA

Matches the Key Stage 2 (Year 5) National Curriculum for English, where pupils are expected to sustain longer, more cohesive writing — broadly equivalent to US Grade 4 Common Core ELA standards. This is our Explorers band, benchmarked primarily to Cambridge Primary English (reading, writing, speaking and listening).

“write a story with a beginning, middle and end”

“explain why a character acted that way”

“join ideas with because, when and although”

Grade 6

B3 · Navigators band

An introduction to literary analysis and Shakespeare, narrative structure, rhetoric, and writing in a distinct voice.

1. Introduction to Literary Analysis
2. Shakespeare: An Introduction
3. Narrative Structures
4. Sentence Variety for Effect
5. Creative Writing: Voice & Viewpoint
6. Rhetoric & Persuasive Techniques
7. Poetry: Form & Structure
8. Media & Digital Texts
9. Presentations & Debate
10. Introduction to Pre-1914 Literature
11. Poetic Devices & Analysis
12. Extended Narrative Writing
13. Comparing Texts
14. Active & Passive Voice
15. Semi-Colons, Colons & Dashes
16. Writing a Personal Essay
17. Rhetorical Devices
18. Historical and Social Context in Texts
19. Travel Writing
20. Formal vs Informal Register
21. Irony and Sarcasm
22. Writing a Book Review

HOW THIS ALIGNS WITH REAL-WORLD CURRICULA

Matches the Key Stage 2 (Year 6) National Curriculum for English, the final year of primary writing composition and grammar before secondary school — broadly equivalent to US Grade 5 Common Core ELA standards. This is our Navigators band, benchmarked primarily to Cambridge Lower Secondary English, also checked against CEFR for English learners.

“explain how a writer makes me feel something”

“debate politely and give reasons”

“use punctuation to make my meaning clear”

Grade 7

B3 · Navigators band

Studying a full novel and a Shakespeare play, comparing viewpoints across texts, and building argumentative essay skills.

1. Studying a Novel
2. Shakespeare: A Full Play
3. Conflict Poetry
4. Complex Sentences & Clauses
5. Genre Conventions
6. Comparing Viewpoints
7. Gothic & Genre Fiction
8. Media Literacy & Bias
9. Argumentative Essay Writing
10. Introduction to World Literature
11. Persuasive Speech Writing
12. Analysing Non-Fiction Texts
13. Introduction to Shakespeare
14. Analysing Dialogue in Fiction
15. Tone & Register
16. Writing a Film/Book Review
17. Narrative Structure (Exposition to Resolution)
18. Character Development Analysis
19. Writing a Persuasive Speech
20. Symbolism in Literature
21. Preparing for a Debate
22. Writing an Autobiographical Piece

HOW THIS ALIGNS WITH REAL-WORLD CURRICULA

Matches the Key Stage 3 (Year 7) National Curriculum for English, where secondary pupils first study a complete novel and a Shakespeare play in full — broadly equivalent to US Grade 6 Common Core ELA standards. This is our Navigators band, benchmarked primarily to Cambridge Lower Secondary English, also checked against CEFR for English learners.

“explain how a writer makes me feel something”

“debate politely and give reasons”

“use punctuation to make my meaning clear”

Grade 8

B3 · Navigators band

Unseen poetry, 19th-century prose, analysing rhetoric, and transactional writing — early GCSE-style exam skills.

1. Unseen Poetry
2. Shakespeare: Essay Writing
3. 19th-Century Prose
4. Modern Prose or Drama
5. Analysing Rhetoric
6. Creative Writing: Crafting for Effect
7. Transactional Writing
8. Spoken Language Study
9. Poetry Anthology Study
10. Comparative Analysis: Exam Skills
11. Media Literacy & Bias
12. Advanced Essay Structure
13. Analysing a Poetry Anthology
14. Satire & Irony
15. Analysing Advertising Language
16. Writing a Formal Letter of Complaint
17. Analysing Bias in Media Texts
18. Introduction to Shakespearean Language
19. Writing a Newspaper Article
20. Introduction to Gothic Fiction
21. Analysing Propaganda Techniques
22. Writing a Film Review

HOW THIS ALIGNS WITH REAL-WORLD CURRICULA

Matches the Key Stage 3 (Year 8) National Curriculum for English; many schools begin introducing GCSE-style analysis skills at this stage, which this unit reflects — broadly equivalent to US Grade 7 Common Core ELA standards. This is our Navigators band, benchmarked primarily to Cambridge Lower Secondary English, also checked against CEFR for English learners.

“explain how a writer makes me feel something”

“debate politely and give reasons”

“use punctuation to make my meaning clear”

Grade 9

B4 · Pathfinders band

GCSE-level non-fiction and fiction analysis, a poetry anthology, spoken language study, and exam technique practice.

1. Non-Fiction Reading & Viewpoint Analysis
2. Fiction Reading: Extracts & Analysis
3. Descriptive & Narrative Writing Techniques
4. Transactional & Persuasive Writing
5. Poetry Anthology: Love and Relationships
6. Studying a Prose Text: Themes & Character
7. Studying Shakespeare: Character & Theme
8. Spoken Language & Presentation Skills
9. Comparing Unseen Poems
10. Exam Technique: Language Paper Practice
11. GCSE Creative Writing Techniques
12. Analysing Unseen Poetry
13. Spoken Language Study
14. GCSE: Analysing Prose Fiction Extracts
15. Comparative Poetry Analysis
16. Writing to Inform / Advise
17. Comparing Unseen Poems
18. Writing a Persuasive Essay
19. Spoken Language Study
20. Social and Historical Context in GCSE Texts
21. Writing an Analytical Essay
22. Analysing 19th and 20th Century Non-fiction

HOW THIS ALIGNS WITH REAL-WORLD CURRICULA

Still within Key Stage 3 (Year 9) nationally, though schools commonly start GCSE English Language and Literature content here to spread the specification over three years, as this unit does — broadly equivalent to US Grade 8 Common Core ELA standards. This is our Pathfinders band, benchmarked primarily to Cambridge Lower Secondary English at IGCSE-adjacent standard, also checked against CEFR for English learners.

“write an analysis of a text I have not seen before”

“summarise several sources in my own words”

“give a confident, formal presentation”

Grade 10

B4 · Pathfinders band

Advanced analysis and synthesis across fiction, non-fiction and poetry, with full exam-style practice and revision strategy.

1. Advanced Non-Fiction Analysis & Synthesis
2. Advanced Fiction Analysis: Structure & Narrative Voice
3. Persuasive Speech Writing
4. Poetry Anthology: Power and Conflict
5. Studying a Prose Text: Context & Critical Interpretation
6. Shakespeare: Extract-Based Essay Writing
7. Comparing Poems Across the Anthology
8. Grammar & Accuracy for GCSE Writing
9. Full Exam-Style Practice: Language Paper
10. Final GCSE English Revision & Exam Strategy
11. GCSE Literature: Themes & Context
12. Advanced Rhetorical Analysis
13. GCSE Exam Technique & Timed Essays
14. GCSE: 19th-Century Literature Context
15. Analysing Multimodal Texts
16. Exam Technique: Analysing an Unseen Prose Extract
17. Analysing Modern Drama Extracts
18. Writing a Critical Comparative Essay
19. Exam Technique for Unseen Poetry
20. Comparing Two Non-fiction Texts
21. Creative Writing Techniques for the Exam
22. Revision and Exam Strategy for English Literature

HOW THIS ALIGNS WITH REAL-WORLD CURRICULA

Matches the Key Stage 4 (GCSE Year 1) (Year 10) — the first year of GCSE English Language and Literature study, with exam technique now a core focus — broadly equivalent to US Grade 9 (Freshman) Common Core ELA standards for that band. This is our Pathfinders band, benchmarked primarily to Cambridge Lower Secondary English at IGCSE-adjacent standard, also checked against CEFR for English learners.

“write an analysis of a text I have not seen before”

“summarise several sources in my own words”

“give a confident, formal presentation”